

3.2.4 Tree Canopy

Objectives

- (a) To protect and increase tree canopy of the LGA.
- (b) To preserve and enhance landscape character.
- (c) To maintain habitat for native fauna.
- (d) To capture the cooling benefits of canopy.
- (e) To support the *Waverley Community Strategic Plan 2022-2032* minimum 29% LGA canopy and shrub cover target.

Controls

- (a) Development must not result in the loss of tree canopy.
- (b) For Development Applications that involve external works, a Landscape Plan must be submitted showing the locations of tree species, other proposed plants species, any existing trees and vegetation to be maintained and the area of the canopy of the Landscape Plan when planting is mature.
- (c) Where a tree that is **3m or more in height or has 3m or more canopy spread** is proposed for removal under a Development Application, replacement planting of suitable species should be planted on the site that maintain or increase the tree canopy on the site when mature.
- (d) Replacement plantings on site must be of the same or greater canopy size when mature than the canopy proposed to be removed as confirmed by a Landscape Plan and Arborist. Replacement trees planted in accordance with control (c) are to be selected from the list of plantings in Annexure B3-2, and **minimum 45L pot sizes**.
- (e) If there is insufficient planting space on site to accommodate a tree of similar dimensions when mature, the applicant will be asked to contribute to offset planting on public land. Generally, for every tree removed, the replacement of a minimum of three (3) off-site trees will be required in accordance with Council's policy.